

COOLIE

5-Minute Short Film — Script & Scenes

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SCENE 1 — THE MORNING (0:00–0:40)

Early morning at a market or loading area. Arun and Kannan, two young brothers, wear the same old clothes they wear every day. They carry large plates or baskets filled with heavy-looking loads on their heads.

Kannan: Brother... how much will we get today?

Arun: If we finish everything... maybe ₹20.

Kannan: ₹20? Then maybe we can eat something good today.

They continue working. Show their tired faces, hands, sweat, worn clothes and the large loads.

SCENE 2 — THE BOSS AND THE WAGE (0:40–1:20)

After working for the day, the brothers approach the boss.

Arun: Sir... our payment?

The boss gives Arun ₹10.

Arun: Sir... we worked the whole day.

Boss: So what?

Arun: You said you would give us ₹20.

Boss: Take the ₹10 and leave. If you don't want it, don't come tomorrow.

Arun silently takes the money. Close-up of the ₹10 note in his dirty hand.

SCENE 3 — THE DREAM OF SCHOOL (1:20–2:00)

In the evening, the brothers sit together in the same work clothes. Kannan sees schoolchildren carrying school bags.

Kannan: Brother... when will I go to school?

Arun: You will.

Kannan: When? I want to study.

Arun cannot answer. Show schoolchildren, Kannan's dirty hands, their worn clothes, the ₹10 note and a nearly empty food plate.

Arun — Voice-over: I promised my brother that his life would be better than mine. But every day... I was losing hope.

SCENE 4 — THE PRESSURE (2:00–2:40)

The brothers return to work the next morning in the same clothes. The boss orders them to work faster. Kannan struggles with a heavy-looking load and Arun helps him.

Kannan: Are you okay, brother?

Arun: Because I can't give you the life you deserve.

Kannan: I don't need anything. I only need you.

Kannan hugs Arun. Arun becomes emotional.

SCENE 5 — ARUN'S BREAKING POINT (2:40–3:20)

At night, Arun walks away alone holding the ₹10 note. He remembers the heavy loads, the boss, Kannan asking about school and their difficult life. He becomes overwhelmed and considers ending his life.

Production note: Do not show a suicide method or graphic action. Focus on Arun's face, tears, trembling hands and the ₹10 note falling.

Ravi: Hey! Stop!

Arun turns around.

SCENE 6 — THE STRANGER (3:20–4:00)

Ravi approaches Arun and asks what happened. He notices the boy's worn clothes and signs of manual labour.

Ravi: Do you work somewhere?

Ravi: How much do you get?

Arun shows the ₹10.

Ravi: ₹10... for a full day's work?

Arun: My brother and I work there. If we don't work... we don't eat.

Ravi: Your life doesn't have to stay like this.

SCENE 7 — THE CONFRONTATION (4:00–4:40)

Ravi returns to the workplace with the brothers.

Ravi: Are these children working for you?

Boss: Yes. What's your problem?

Ravi: How much do you pay them?

Boss: That's none of your business. They need the money. I'm giving them work.

Ravi: They need education, not exploitation. Child labour is illegal. You cannot employ and exploit children like this.

The boss becomes silent.

SCENE 8 — A NEW BEGINNING (4:40–5:00)

The next morning. Arun and Kannan are no longer carrying the heavy plates. Kannan carries a school bag as they walk toward a school.

Kannan: Brother... are we really going to school?

Arun: Yes.

Final visual: the large work plate lies empty. Cut to Kannan's school bag.

BLACK SCREEN

COOLIE

“Children are meant to carry dreams, not heavy loads.”

“STOP CHILD LABOUR. LET CHILDREN LEARN. LET CHILDREN LIVE.”